

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Rubio: US won't govern Venezuela

Secretary of state's remarks contrast with Trump's view from day before, emphasize oil 'quarantine'

By Regina Garcia Cano, Matthew Lee, Will Weissert and Eric Tucker
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — Secretary of State Marco Rubio suggested Sunday that the United States

would not govern Venezuela day-to-day other than enforcing an existing "oil quarantine" on the country, a turnaround after President Donald Trump announced a day earlier that the U.S. would be running Venezuela following its ouster of leader Nicolás Maduro.

Rubio's statements on TV talk shows seemed designed to temper concerns about whether the assertive American action to achieve regime change might again produce a prolonged foreign intervention or failed attempt at nation-building.

They stood in contrast to Trump's broad but vague claims that the U.S. would at least temporarily "run" the oil-rich nation,

comments that suggested some sort of governing structure under which Caracas would be controlled by Washington.

Rubio offered a more nuanced take, saying the U.S. would continue to enforce an oil quarantine on sanctioned tankers before Maduro was removed from power early Saturday and use that leverage to press policy changes in Venezuela.

■ How Trump settled on a loyalist of Nicolás Maduro to be Venezuela's next leader. **Nation & World**

"And so that's the sort of control the president is pointing to when he says that," Rubio said on CBS' "Face the Nation." "We continue with that quarantine, and we

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LIONS 19, BEARS 16



ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

ON TO THE PLAYOFFS

Bears quarterback Caleb Williams, center, walks off the field after the Detroit Lions defeated the Bears 19-16 at Soldier Field in Chicago on Sunday. The loss dropped the Bears to 11-6 for the season, but they locked up the No. 2 seed in the NFC playoffs with the Philadelphia Eagles' loss to the Washington Commanders. **Coverage in Chicago Sports**

ELECTION 2026 COOK COUNTY

Candidates differ in wealth, disclosure

Dem hopefuls give picture of finances in tax, ethics filings

By A.D. Quig
Chicago Tribune

As Cook County voters begin to decide who will oversee billions in public spending and the county's property tax system, a review of tax returns from leading Democratic candidates shows sharply different sources of wealth, investment strategies and levels of financial disclosure.

Two-term incumbent Assessor Fritz Kaegi reported seven-figure investment gains, and he paid nearly \$780,000 in combined state and federal taxes over four years. His challenger, Lyons Township Assessor Patrick Hynes, disclosed income from several suburban properties he owns.

Four-term County Board President Toni Preckwinkle relied on her public salary, pension and Social Security income, while her challenger, Brendan Reilly, made do with his Chicago aldermanic salary and a recent reentry into media production work.

The Chicago Tribune requested the past four years of tax returns from the Democratic candidates for Cook County Board president and assessor and compared them with mandatory statements of economic interest filed with the Cook County clerk and the Chicago Board of Ethics. The exercise, voluntary but common in major elections, offers a window into candidates' financial lives — including potential conflicts of interest — and into how much information each is willing to share with voters.

The candidates varied slightly in what they provided.

Turn to Candidates, Page 2



Edith Renfrow Smith works during an arts and crafts class in 2017 at Bethany Retirement Community in Andersonville. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

EDITH RENFROW SMITH 1914-2026

'SuperAger' stayed sharp well past 100

Former Chicago teacher participated in NU longevity study

By Bob Goldsborough
Chicago Tribune

Edith Renfrow Smith, the first Black woman to graduate from Grinnell College in Iowa and a longtime Chicago schoolteacher,

remained mentally sharp well past 100, becoming the subject for medical researchers studying what they called "SuperAgers."

Smith, 111, died Friday in Chicago.

Edith Renfrow was born in Grinnell, Iowa, on July 14, 1914, the fifth of six children. Her grandparents, George Craig and Eliza Jan Craig, were born into slavery. Her father was a hotel chef.

The Renfrows were one of the only African American families in Grinnell at that time, and her parents stressed the importance of education for all of their children.

"My mother insisted that education was the only thing that could not be taken away from them," Smith told National Public

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Outreach workers hope fentanyl detection devices will save lives

By Angie Leventis Lourgos
Chicago Tribune

A young man approached a card table set up under the Green Line tracks on the city's West Side and asked the woman behind it if she had any clean needles or naloxone, a medication that can reverse the effects of an opioid overdose.

While rummaging through a box of supplies in search of those items, the woman also handed him another small package: a fentanyl detection device, which is designed

to screen illicit drugs for the presence of that highly potent — and potentially fatal — substance.

Fentanyl, a synthetic opioid 100 times stronger than morphine, is often mixed in with other narcotics or pressed into counterfeit pills, posing a high risk of overdose for unsuspecting users and the leading cause of death for Americans aged 18 to 45, according to the Drug Enforcement Administration.

The woman, who works for the local nonprofit West Side Heroin/Opioid Task Force, briefly

explained how the device works as the man slipped the package into his coat pocket.

"It's pretty cool," she added. "Stay safe."

Roughly a dozen outreach workers for the task force fanned out across the West Side on a recent weekday to distribute fentanyl detection devices, one of several drug harm mitigation strategies the organization uses to try to keep the community safer as well

Turn to Fentanyl, Page 4



Adam Rangoon distributes Narcan and Defent, a fentanyl detection device, along West Lake Street during an outreach event on Tuesday in Chicago's West Garfield Park neighborhood. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

College considers name change

North Central College in Naperville is examining its image and hopes to improve its branding. **Page 2**

Jan. 6 officers still struggle

Five years after the Capitol siege, some are still coming to terms with what happened. **Nation & World**

Tough choices over ACA costs

Many Americans are weighing their next steps as the cost of their health coverage skyrockets. **Nation & World**

TODAY'S
WEATHER



High 41 Low 35

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 10

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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